

Render Plans and Service Billing Documentation

This document provides a clear and simple explanation of how Render pricing, service billing, limits, and plan upgrades work. This avoids confusion and helps you understand exactly what you get when you upgrade individual services.

1. Render Billing Structure

Render uses **per-service billing**, meaning:

- Each **web service** has its own plan
- Each **database** has its own plan
- Each **background worker** has its own plan
- Each **cron job** has its own plan

You receive **one combined monthly invoice**, but:

- Plans do **not share benefits**
- Free limits do **not combine** across services

2. Free Tier Limits (per service)

Each free-tier service receives:

- 750 instance hours per month (per service)
- 500 build minutes per month (per account)
- Service sleeps after inactivity
- Slower CPU & RAM
- Cold starts when users access after sleep

3. Paid Plans (Starter Plan – \$7/month for Web Services)

- If you upgrade **one web service** to the \$7 Starter plan, it gets:
- Unlimited instance hours (No 750-hour limit)
- Zero downtime (always running)
- Faster CPU (0.5+) and RAM
- No sleep mode
- Faster deployment
- Production-ready performance
- Important:
- Upgrading one service does NOT upgrade other services in the same project.

4. Paid PostgreSQL Database (\$6/month Starter)

- Upgrading your database gives:
- Permanent database (no more 90-day expiry)
- 1 GB RAM and 0.5 CPU
- 20 GB storage
- Daily automatic backups
- No sleep mode
- Faster queries and stable performance
- More concurrent connections
- Free databases do **not** get these benefits.

5. Multiple Services in the Same Project

Even if you create:

- Multiple web services
- Inside the same Render project

6. Recommended Upgrade Strategy

Minimum cost for production stability:

- Upgrade main API web service → \$7
- Upgrade database → \$6
- Keep other services free unless necessary

Total stable monthly cost: \$13

7. Do Paid Service Hours Affect Free Services?

No. Even though Render shows one billing summary, free-tier limits are not shared.

- Service A using more hours does not affect Service B.
- Free limits apply individually per service.

